

Cyclic Sighing & Extended Exhale

CALM 2 min Opener / rescue Evidence A Rhythmic Pacing

WHY THIS EARNS A PLACE

Use this when anxiety is showing up physically and the person needs a fast, body-first entry point. Two gentle inhales followed by an easy, longer exhale creates a simple rhythm that asks for almost no reflection. It earns a place because it can reduce activation before the user is ready for a cognitive exercise.

SCIENCE, KEPT HONEST

A randomized trial found daily five-minute cyclic sighing improved mood and reduced respiratory rate. That supports exhale-focused breathwork generally, not a guarantee of immediate relief for every user.

[Balban et al., 2023 - randomized trial](#)

HOW WE MAKE IT ENGAGING

CORE EXPERIENCE

A living breath ribbon expands twice, then travels further across the screen on the exhale. The motion does the teaching, so the user can follow without reading timing instructions.

INTERACTION + PERSONALISATION

Offer 3, 5 or 8 comfortable cycles; let the user slow the pace; use optional soft haptics at each turning point. Never reward breath-holding or force depth.

VISUAL + AUDIO DIRECTION

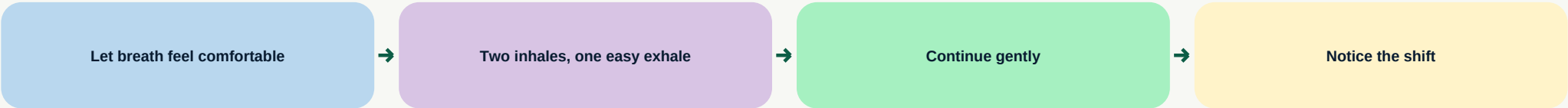
Warm, sparse narration. A soft two-note rise for the double inhale and one long falling tone for the exhale; no busy background track.

STANDOUT FEATURE

The extended exhale visibly carries a cloud of tension out of the frame, making the physiological idea instantly understandable and memorable.

CURRENT CODED PATHWAY

Names and order preserved from the active 25-intervention catalogue



Solvable or Hypothetical Worry?

CALM / FOCUS 3 min Core Evidence B+ Cognitive Sorting + Offloading

WHY THIS EARNS A PLACE

Use this when worry is looping because the person has not separated a real problem from a future 'what if'. The intervention directs actionable worries toward one practical step and contains hypothetical worries instead of feeding them. It earns a place because the two kinds of worry require different responses.

SCIENCE, KEPT HONEST

This distinction follows CBT worry-management practice: problem-solve current concerns and postpone or redirect attention from hypothetical worry. Evidence is stronger for full CBT and problem-solving therapy than for this micro-tool alone.

[CCI - Problem-Solving for Worry](#)

HOW WE MAKE IT ENGAGING

CORE EXPERIENCE

The worry arrives as one card and the user slides it onto one of two clearly different paths: ACT ON IT or NOT FOR NOW. Each path changes the next screen rather than delivering generic advice.

INTERACTION + PERSONALISATION

If solvable, build one verb-led next step and choose when to do it. If hypothetical, place it in a sealed parking slot with an optional review time.

VISUAL + AUDIO DIRECTION

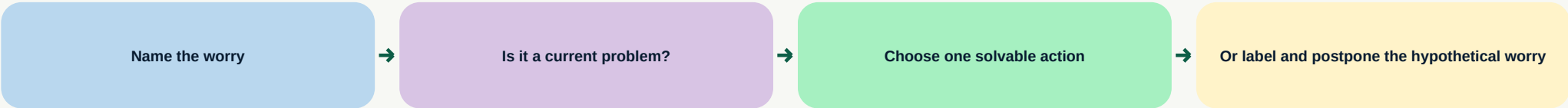
Calm, matter-of-fact voice; small paper-slide sounds; silence after the choice so the person can think without being rushed.

STANDOUT FEATURE

The sorting decision immediately transforms into the correct tool: a next-action card or a contained worry card.

CURRENT CODED PATHWAY

Names and order preserved from the active 25-intervention catalogue



Energy Ladder

LIFT 3 min Opener Evidence B+ Personalised Choice Pathway + Action Initiation

WHY THIS EARNS A PLACE

Use this when low energy makes normal tasks feel too large. The person starts from their actual capacity, chooses a low, medium or higher rung, and completes one realistic action now. It earns a place because it turns 'do something' into a calibrated choice and makes success possible on a difficult day.

SCIENCE, KEPT HONEST

Behavioral activation has evidence for reducing depressive symptoms, including in digital formats. A graded ladder lowers the threshold to action, although evidence is for the broader method rather than this exact three-minute sequence.

[Alber et al., 2023 - digital BA meta-analysis](#)

HOW WE MAKE IT ENGAGING

CORE EXPERIENCE

A vertical ladder begins at the user's current energy, not at zero. Each rung reveals three tiny actions matched to that capacity, making the pathway feel personal rather than prescriptive.

INTERACTION + PERSONALISATION

Tap an energy level; choose or write one action; complete it in-app where possible; optionally save a favourite action for future low-energy days.

VISUAL + AUDIO DIRECTION

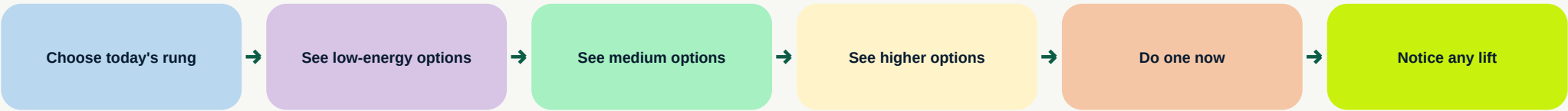
Light, encouraging narration without hype. A gentle upward musical motif marks selection and completion, but no points, streak pressure or failure state.

STANDOUT FEATURE

The character or light moves only one rung - visually reinforcing that progress means the next achievable movement, not reaching the top.

CURRENT CODED PATHWAY

Names and order preserved from the active 25-intervention catalogue



Test the Prediction

LIFT / CALM 4 min Core Evidence A- Cognitive Sorting + Action Initiation

WHY THIS EARNS A PLACE

Use this when avoidance is being driven by a confident negative prediction. The person states what they expect, designs a fair real-world test, then compares the result with the prediction. It earns a place because insight alone often does not update a belief; direct evidence from experience can.

SCIENCE, KEPT HONEST

Behavioral experiments test beliefs against observable experience. Reviews suggest they can add value within CBT, but the evidence does not isolate this short app-based version.

[McMillan & Lee, 2010 - systematic review](#)

HOW WE MAKE IT ENGAGING

CORE EXPERIENCE

A compact 'field lab' turns the prediction into a testable card. Before and after confidence dials stay visible so learning is concrete rather than buried in reflection text.

INTERACTION + PERSONALISATION

The user selects a safe test size, writes an observable outcome and can return later to record what happened. Add a safety check before tests involving people, driving, substances or physical risk.

VISUAL + AUDIO DIRECTION

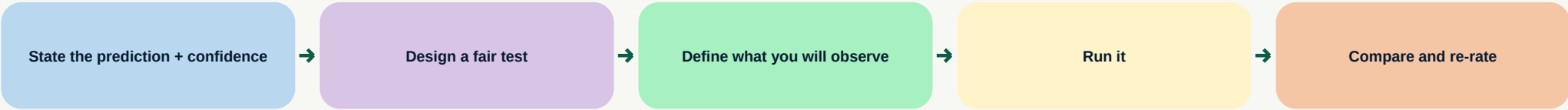
Curious, non-judgmental voice: 'We are collecting information, not proving you wrong.' Subtle click and reveal sounds only.

STANDOUT FEATURE

A side-by-side PREDICTION / REALITY reveal preserves uncertainty and shows exactly what the user learned.

CURRENT CODED PATHWAY

Names and order preserved from the active 25-intervention catalogue



Change the Scene

LIFT 2 min Opener / core Evidence B Spatial Attention Mapping + Action Initiation

WHY THIS EARNS A PLACE

Use this when someone feels flat or stuck and the current setting is reinforcing inertia. A small move - another chair, room, doorway or outdoor spot - changes the cues around them and creates a fresh starting point. It earns a place because it works even when the person cannot generate motivation through thought alone.

SCIENCE, KEPT HONEST

Changing context may interrupt environmental cues, while behavioral activation supports small outward actions. Direct clinical evidence for this exact 'scene change' mechanism is limited, so position it as a supportive reset.

[Alber et al., 2023 - digital BA meta-analysis](#)

HOW WE MAKE IT ENGAGING

CORE EXPERIENCE

The opening screen is a visual doorway. The user picks the smallest available scene change, then the app's palette and ambient layer shift when they arrive.

INTERACTION + PERSONALISATION

Offer realistic options: turn your chair, stand at a window, move rooms, step outside. Optional motion sensing can confirm movement but must never be required.

VISUAL + AUDIO DIRECTION

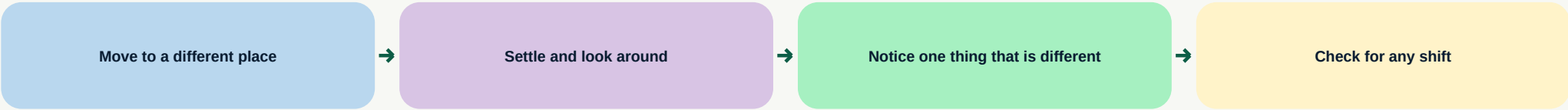
A brief transition swell followed by a new ambient soundscape; narration leaves space for looking rather than filling the two minutes.

STANDOUT FEATURE

A BEFORE / AFTER split lets the person capture one word for each scene, turning a subtle environmental shift into visible evidence.

CURRENT CODED PATHWAY

Names and order preserved from the active 25-intervention catalogue



Nature Reset

LIFT / GROUND 3 min Core Evidence A- Spatial Attention Mapping + Sequential Discovery

WHY THIS EARNS A PLACE

Use this for mild stress, low mood or mental fatigue when some contact with a natural element is available. The sequence guides attention toward sky, air, colour and sound rather than asking the person to 'relax'. It earns a place because it combines a real environment change with low-effort sensory engagement.

SCIENCE, KEPT HONEST

Reviews associate nature exposure with lower perceived and physiological stress, but findings and study quality vary. This should be framed as a brief supportive reset, not a primary treatment.

[Shuda et al., 2020 - systematic review](#)

HOW WE MAKE IT ENGAGING

CORE EXPERIENCE

A 'nature radar' reveals one sensory discovery at a time. Each real-world observation adds a colour, motion or sound to a quiet digital landscape.

INTERACTION + PERSONALISATION

Let users choose outdoor, window or indoor-plant mode. They tap colours they actually see and name or record one sound; camera and microphone remain optional.

VISUAL + AUDIO DIRECTION

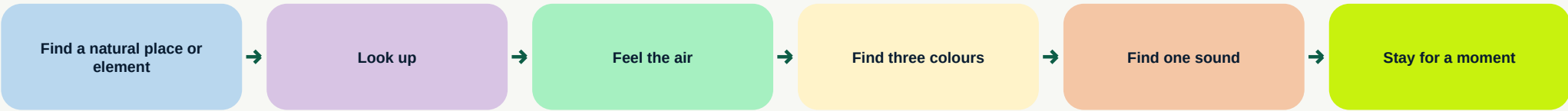
Minimal guidance with generous pauses. If ambient nature audio is offered, clearly label it as optional so it does not compete with the user's real surroundings.

STANDOUT FEATURE

The app builds a personal nature palette from the user's three colours, producing a unique closing scene without gamifying the exercise.

CURRENT CODED PATHWAY

Names and order preserved from the active 25-intervention catalogue



One Values Step

LIFT / FOCUS 3 min Core Evidence B+ Personalised Choice Pathway + Action Initiation

WHY THIS EARNS A PLACE

Use this when someone has lost direction or motivation and symptom reduction is not enough to move them. They identify what matters in this moment and take one tiny action in that direction. It earns a place because it reconnects action to meaning, which can make effort feel worthwhile even before mood improves.

SCIENCE, KEPT HONEST

ACT research links values and committed action with psychological flexibility and reduced distress. Evidence supports the broader therapeutic process more strongly than a single brief values prompt.

[Macri & Rogge. 2024 - meta-analytic review](#)

HOW WE MAKE IT ENGAGING

CORE EXPERIENCE

A quiet compass presents a small set of human directions - care, courage, learning, connection, responsibility - plus a write-your-own option. The chosen value then shapes the action prompt.

INTERACTION + PERSONALISATION

Pick a value, select or write a step that takes under five minutes, and choose NOW or SCHEDULE. Save recurring values privately if the user wants personalisation.

VISUAL + AUDIO DIRECTION

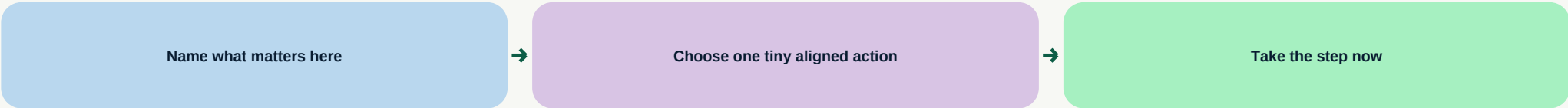
Warm and spacious, never moralising. One soft tonal resolution as the compass settles on the chosen direction.

STANDOUT FEATURE

The compass moves when direction becomes clear, not when the task is completed - reinforcing direction over performance.

CURRENT CODED PATHWAY

Names and order preserved from the active 25-intervention catalogue



Orienting Scan

GROUND / CALM 2 min Rescue / opener Evidence B+ Spatial Attention Mapping + Sequential Discovery

WHY THIS EARNS A PLACE

Use this when panic, threat or disorientation has narrowed attention. The person slowly locates the room's edges and three neutral or reassuring features, then names where they are now. It earns a place because it brings attention out of internal alarm and back into the current environment with very low cognitive demand.

SCIENCE, KEPT HONEST

Present-focused sensory orientation is used in grounding practice to reconnect people with current surroundings. Direct evidence for a standalone two-minute digital orienting scan is limited.

[US VA - present-focus grounding resource](#)

HOW WE MAKE IT ENGAGING

CORE EXPERIENCE

The screen behaves like a panoramic frame. As the user turns their gaze to three points, those points illuminate and the frame becomes stable and complete.

INTERACTION + PERSONALISATION

Tap each anchor after finding it; offer seated and public-place modes; keep camera use optional. The final orientation phrase can be read, spoken or heard.

VISUAL + AUDIO DIRECTION

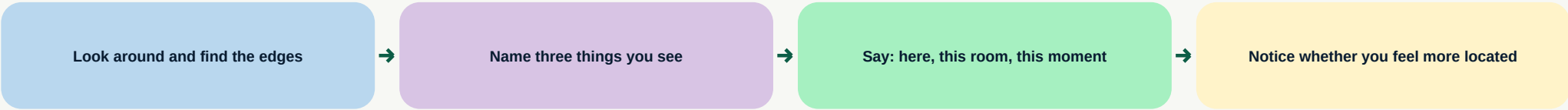
Low, steady voice with longer pauses. Stereo ambience begins narrow and subtly widens as the visual frame completes.

STANDOUT FEATURE

The room's edges close into a strong visual frame, giving the abstract feeling of 'being here' a concrete form.

CURRENT CODED PATHWAY

Names and order preserved from the active 25-intervention catalogue



Name What You're Feeling

GROUND / CALM / RESET

2 min

Core

Evidence A-

Emotional Wave Tracking + Language Transformation

WHY THIS EARNS A PLACE

Use this when emotion feels intense but unclear. The person chooses the closest feeling word, rates its strength and identifies a likely trigger without needing a perfect explanation. It earns a place because naming creates definition: the emotion becomes something the user can observe and respond to rather than an undifferentiated state.

SCIENCE, KEPT HONEST

Affect-labeling studies suggest that putting feelings into words can reduce aspects of emotional reactivity. The evidence supports the mechanism, but this brief digital sequence still needs product-level testing.

[Lieberman et al., 2007 - affect-labeling study](#)

HOW WE MAKE IT ENGAGING

CORE EXPERIENCE

A soft, searchable emotion field starts broad and becomes more precise as the user taps. The chosen feeling becomes a bounded shape with visible space around it.

INTERACTION + PERSONALISATION

Support broad-to-specific words, mixed feelings and 'not sure'. The intensity control changes size and motion rather than using red danger colours; trigger entry is optional.

VISUAL + AUDIO DIRECTION

Validating but restrained: 'Closest is enough.' No triumphant completion sound; use a single grounding tone after the final label.

STANDOUT FEATURE

The emotional shape remains present but no longer fills the screen - a visual metaphor for naming without suppressing.

CURRENT CODED PATHWAY

Names and order preserved from the active 25-intervention catalogue

Choose the closest feeling word



Rate strength from 1-10



Name the likely trigger



Say or read the full label

Next Physical Step

FOCUS 1 min Opener Evidence B+ Action Initiation & Timing

WHY THIS EARNS A PLACE

Use this when a task feels mentally large and the person cannot begin. The intervention converts an abstract project into one visible physical action such as 'open the document' or 'put the plate in the sink'. It earns a place because it removes planning load at the exact point where paralysis occurs.

SCIENCE, KEPT HONEST

Research on implementation intentions suggests that specific cue-linked actions can help bridge the intention-action gap. This supports concrete planning, while the one-minute micro-step itself should not be presented as a standalone treatment.

[Toli et al., 2016 - implementation-intention meta-analysis](#)

HOW WE MAKE IT ENGAGING

CORE EXPERIENCE

A foggy task cloud collapses into one crisp action tile. The app actively coaches vague language into a physical verb and object.

INTERACTION + PERSONALISATION

Type or speak the task; receive editable examples; press START to launch a brief initiation cue. A skip option prevents the timer becoming another demand.

VISUAL + AUDIO DIRECTION

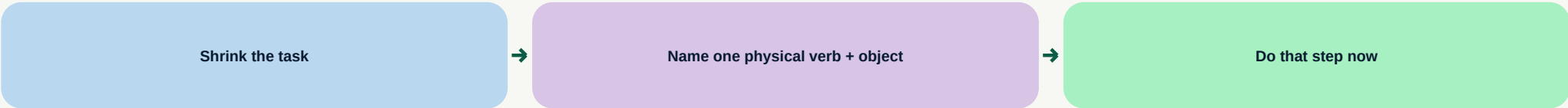
Direct, friendly and minimal. One clean start tone; silence while the user performs the action.

STANDOUT FEATURE

The overwhelming project literally folds down into one tappable card that remains on screen until the first movement is made.

CURRENT CODED PATHWAY

Names and order preserved from the active 25-intervention catalogue



Friction Sweep

FOCUS 2 min Opener Evidence A- Action Initiation & Timing

WHY THIS EARNS A PLACE

Use this when the person wants to begin but the environment keeps winning: an unopened file, missing material, noisy phone or unclear setup. They remove one obstacle and quiet one competing cue before starting. It earns a place because motivation is not always the problem; the path may simply contain too much friction.

SCIENCE, KEPT HONEST

Behaviour is sensitive to opportunity, cues and environmental friction, and restructuring settings can alter action in some health domains. Direct mental-health evidence for this two-minute sweep remains limited.

[Wilkie et al., 2019 - environment restructuring review](#)

HOW WE MAKE IT ENGAGING

CORE EXPERIENCE

A simple workspace scan shows four friction types: access, clutter, distraction and uncertainty. Choosing one opens a single practical removal action.

INTERACTION + PERSONALISATION

Swipe away one barrier, launch Do Not Disturb via instructions where supported, gather one needed item, or pre-open the correct screen. Then hand off directly to the task.

VISUAL + AUDIO DIRECTION

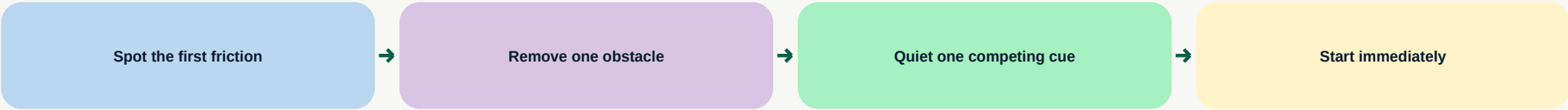
Crisp and purposeful; small clearing sounds with no productivity-game fanfare.

STANDOUT FEATURE

A visible path clears as friction is removed, then becomes the START button - the intervention and the task are one continuous motion.

CURRENT CODED PATHWAY

Names and order preserved from the active 25-intervention catalogue



WOOP

FOCUS / LIFT 4 min Core Evidence A Action Initiation & Timing + Personalised Choice

WHY THIS EARNS A PLACE

Use this when someone has a meaningful goal but optimism alone is not producing action. They identify the wish and desired outcome, face the main internal obstacle, then create an if-then response. It earns a place because it joins motivation with realistic planning rather than treating them as separate problems.

SCIENCE, KEPT HONEST

A meta-analysis found mental contrasting with implementation intentions produced a small-to-medium improvement in goal attainment, with some publication-bias caution. It is a brief self-regulation strategy, not a guarantee of success.

[Wang et al., 2021 - MCII meta-analysis](#)

HOW WE MAKE IT ENGAGING

CORE EXPERIENCE

Four connected tiles form a short narrative. The obstacle tile rotates and becomes the bridge into the plan, showing that the barrier supplies the cue for action.

INTERACTION + PERSONALISATION

One concise response per tile, voice or text. Provide editable if-then examples and let the user save, schedule or rehearse the final plan.

VISUAL + AUDIO DIRECTION

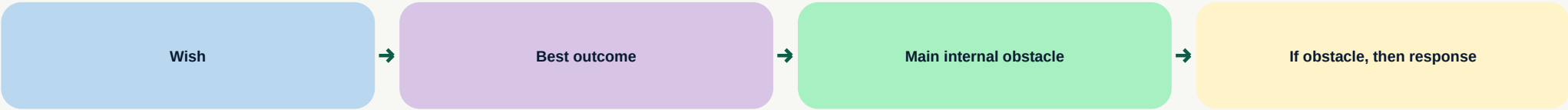
Forward-moving but reflective. A four-note motif gains one layer per tile and resolves only when the if-then plan is usable.

STANDOUT FEATURE

The user's own obstacle transforms into the trigger for the response - a memorable visual explanation of how WOOP works.

CURRENT CODED PATHWAY

Names and order preserved from the active 25-intervention catalogue



Distraction Dump

FOCUS / SLEEP 4 min Opener Evidence B+ Cognitive Offloading & Containment + Cognitive Sorting

WHY THIS EARNS A PLACE

Use this when reminders, ideas and unfinished tasks are competing for working attention. The person captures mental tabs quickly, identifies the true next item and parks the remainder. It earns a place because trying not to forget everything can itself consume the attention needed for work or rest.

SCIENCE, KEPT HONEST

Cognitive offloading uses external tools to reduce reliance on internal memory, and reminder research shows it can improve prospective-task performance. The benefit depends on having a trustworthy place to retrieve what was parked.

[Gilbert et al., 2022 - intention-offloading review](#)

HOW WE MAKE IT ENGAGING

CORE EXPERIENCE

Floating browser-like tabs drift into a calm inbox as the user captures each thought. Organisation is deliberately delayed so capture stays fast.

INTERACTION + PERSONALISATION

Rapid one-line entry by voice or text; circle one item; send the rest to a dated parking container. The saved list must be easy to find later or containment loses credibility.

VISUAL + AUDIO DIRECTION

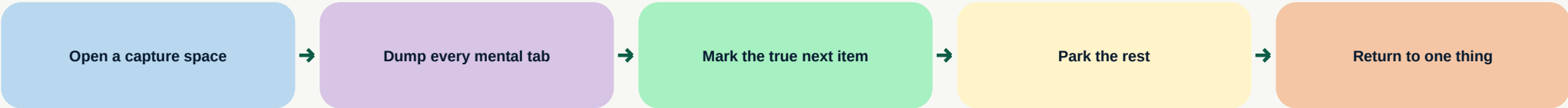
Soft paper and closing-lid sounds. Narration is brief and explicitly gives permission not to solve anything during capture.

STANDOUT FEATURE

The container closes while the one selected focus card remains outside and centred - offloading and prioritisation shown in one image.

CURRENT CODED PATHWAY

Names and order preserved from the active 25-intervention catalogue



Awake-in-Bed Reset

SLEEP 3 min Rescue Evidence A Action Initiation & Timing (sleep specialist)

WHY THIS EARNS A PLACE

Use this after prolonged wakefulness in bed, when clock-checking and effort are strengthening the association between bed and alertness. The person stops monitoring time, briefly moves to a quiet low-stimulation activity, and returns when sleepy. It earns a place because it gives a clear behavioural pathway at a moment when decision-making is poor.

SCIENCE, KEPT HONEST

Stimulus control is conditionally recommended as a single-component therapy for chronic insomnia in the AASM guideline. Persistent sleep problems still warrant assessment and full CBT-I may be more appropriate.

[AASM, 2021 - insomnia treatment guideline](#)

HOW WE MAKE IT ENGAGING

CORE EXPERIENCE

A very low-light pathway replaces a timer. The interface offers only the next decision, protecting the user from stimulating choices and clock arithmetic.

INTERACTION + PERSONALISATION

Choose one quiet activity from a short personalised list; tap 'sleepy now' when ready to return. No elapsed-time display, streaks, notifications or bright completion screen.

VISUAL + AUDIO DIRECTION

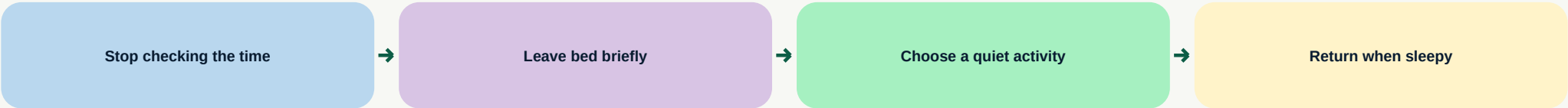
Optional near-whisper guidance and dark ambient sound. Default to silence after the plan is clear.

STANDOUT FEATURE

A user-controlled SLEEPINESS GATE opens the path back to bed; readiness, not a countdown, determines progression.

CURRENT CODED PATHWAY

Names and order preserved from the active 25-intervention catalogue



Drop the Sleep Struggle

SLEEP 4 min Core / closer Evidence A- Language Transformation + Emotional Wave Tracking

WHY THIS EARNS A PLACE

Use this when the effort to force sleep has become the source of alertness and frustration. The intervention removes sleep as a performance task, allows wakefulness and redirects attention from measurement to rest. It earns a place because it targets the struggle around sleeplessness rather than adding another technique the user must perform correctly.

SCIENCE, KEPT HONEST

A systematic review found paradoxical intention improved several insomnia outcomes and reduced sleep-related performance anxiety, though stronger modern studies are still needed.

[Jansson-Frojmark et al., 2022 - meta-analysis](#)

HOW WE MAKE IT ENGAGING

CORE EXPERIENCE

The interface progressively removes demands. 'I must sleep' softens into 'I can rest', controls fade and the screen stops asking the user to achieve anything.

INTERACTION + PERSONALISATION

No progress bar, scores or fixed finish. The user can listen, read once, dim immediately or leave the app. Keep any breathing support passive and optional.

VISUAL + AUDIO DIRECTION

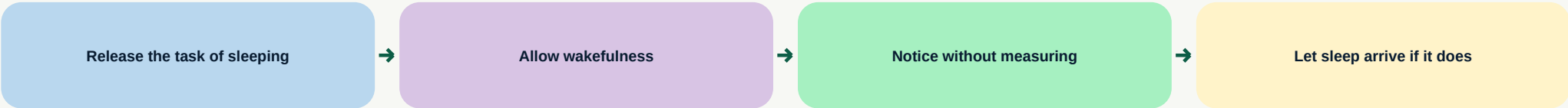
Slow, permissive narration with long silence. Avoid verbal countdowns and obvious track endings that invite monitoring.

STANDOUT FEATURE

The product itself lets go: interaction decreases until only a dark resting field remains, embodying the intervention rather than merely explaining it.

CURRENT CODED PATHWAY

Names and order preserved from the active 25-intervention catalogue



Warm and Heavy

SLEEP / CALM

5 min

Closer

Evidence B+

Interactive Body Mapping + Language Transformation

WHY THIS EARNS A PLACE

Use this when physical tension or bodily alertness is interfering with settling. Repeated warmth-and-heaviness phrases guide attention through the limbs and then the whole body. It earns a place because it provides a passive, low-decision alternative for users who do not want active muscle tensing or breath control.

SCIENCE, KEPT HONEST

Meta-analytic evidence for autogenic training reports benefits across several conditions, including anxiety and functional sleep problems. Effects vary, and the full trained method is broader than this five-minute adaptation.

[Stetter & Kupper, 2002 - meta-analysis](#)

HOW WE MAKE IT ENGAGING

CORE EXPERIENCE

A softly illustrated body map accumulates warmth and visual weight region by region. The glow does not demand accurate tapping; it simply mirrors the narrated progression.

INTERACTION + PERSONALISATION

Choose voice, pace and body-position mode. Let users skip uncomfortable regions, reduce warmth imagery or switch to neutral 'supported and still' language.

VISUAL + AUDIO DIRECTION

Low, unhurried voice over a barely moving drone; gentle stereo placement follows each side of the body, then centres.

STANDOUT FEATURE

Warmth and heaviness accumulate across the silhouette until the whole figure settles lower in the frame - an immersive bodily ending without a success score.

CURRENT CODED PATHWAY

Names and order preserved from the active 25-intervention catalogue

